8 April Cables concerning the Middle East continue to be released, while protests continue across much of the region. A number of cables from 2009 and 2010 show that the US embassy in Yemen was repeatedly informed by local contacts about the weakness and unpopularity of their ally President Saleh, who now faces angry protests.

21 April A cable from Dubai details claims that Iranian President Mahmoud Ahmadinejad is grooming his chief-of-staff Esfandiar Rahim Mashaei as a future replacement. Mashaei is seen as a rival to Iranian hardliners, opposing greater clerical involvement in politics.

25 April WikiLeaks and nine other media organisations begin to release the Guantánamo files – a dossier of 'Detainee Assessment Briefs' kept by the Joint Task Force Guantánamo. The documents, which cover 765 out of 779 prisoners, reveal records of health assessment, the story of how they came to be detained, the reasons for their continued detention, and the evidence against them.

Dozens, perhaps hundreds, of prisoners, are detained on extraordinarily flimsy evidence, and sometimes no evidence at all. One man is detained because he worked for the news channel Al Jazeera, and therefore thought to have useful information about the channel or people he had met in the course of his work; another man because he might know about terrorist activities in a certain region as a result of his work as a taxi-driver. Other detainee assessments speak to deeper issues with American strategy – having a link to Pakistani intelligence services is listed on the 'matrix of threat indicators', despite the fact that Pakistan is a key American ally in the War on Terror.

As American journalist Glenn Greenwald writes, 'How oppressive is this American detention system, how unreliable the evidence is on which the accusations are based . . . the idea of trusting the government to imprison people for life based on secret, untested evidence never reviewed by a court should repel any decent or minimally rational person, but these newly released files demonstrate how warped is this indefinite detention policy specifically.'